

Governed Data Service

Correct an inspection record without losing its history - or exposing a half-published dataset.

REVIEWED CHANGES | VERSIONED DATA

THE PROBLEM

An analyst finds an incorrect value in a fictional equipment inspection. Editing a data file directly can erase evidence, overwrite a newer correction, or leave readers with an incomplete dataset. This project makes the correction a reviewed, versioned operation.

THE WORKFLOW

Propose a create, update or soft delete; switch to a separate reviewer; approve or reject with a reason. Readers see the current dataset and can inspect immutable historical snapshots. The console also walks through an expand, backfill and contract schema change.

HOW A CORRECTION BECOMES PUBLISHED DATA



THE ENGINEERING DECISION

SQLite is the authoritative journal. A writer builds and verifies new Parquet files before committing the snapshot pointer together with the record change and audit event. Readers resolve a committed pointer; publication never means overwriting the previous dataset.

WHAT THIS MAKES INSPECTABLE

FastAPI validation; role-aware review; optimistic revisions; idempotent retries; auditable soft deletion; partition manifests and hashes; failure recovery; and old/new client compatibility during a schema transition.

Evidence and tradeoffs

Inspect retries, competing edits and interrupted publication alongside the successful workflow.

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VERIFIED RELEASE

15 automated tests passed. The review workflow was exercised in a browser. See docs/VALIDATION.md and output/release_evidence.json for test scope, environment and visual-review evidence.

Retries	Same request replays its receipt; changed content under the same key conflicts.
Competing edits	Approval rechecks the record revision inside the write transaction.
Interrupted publish	Injected failures leave the prior committed snapshot readable.
History and integrity	Old versions remain readable; corrupt snapshot content is rejected.
Schema evolution	Expand, backfill and contract preserve values and enforce client compatibility.

LIMITS WORTH DISCUSSING

Switchable identities are a local simulation, not authentication. Snapshot creation holds SQLite's single-writer transaction. Failed writes may leave unreferenced files; the journal is not tamper-proof. Durability depends on the local operating system and filesystem. Cloud storage, distributed commits, production IAM and disaster recovery are outside this release.

TEN-MINUTE INTERVIEW WALKTHROUGH

Correct and review a value. Replay a request and provoke a stale edit. Compare historical snapshots. Walk old and new clients through migration. Then explain what would change for a multi-user production deployment. The included walkthrough supplies prompts and answers.

DATA AND METHODOLOGY

Inspection data and rules are synthetic. No employer code or data is used. Results describe the local implementation; production authentication, distributed operation and durability require separate engineering.